

2c. Content of Research methods (Component 01)

This component introduces and develops knowledge and understanding of the process of planning, conducting, analysing and reporting psychological research across a range of experimental and non-experimental methodologies and techniques.

It promotes an understanding of the methods of scientific enquiry used in empirical research and aims to develop relevant knowledge and skills for this process. It also encourages the acquisition of a range of evaluative concepts for reviewing and discussing the design and outcomes of research, and the application of such knowledge in the wider community.

Competency and confidence in a variety of mathematical procedures and problem-solving skills should also be gained through involvement with practical work associated with the concepts covered.

Where possible and appropriate, links should be made with the content of the other components for example, to illustrate the use of a particular statistical technique or application of evaluative issues.

Research methods and techniques

1.1 Research methods and techniques	Learners should have knowledge and understanding of the following research methods and techniques and their associated strengths and weaknesses:
Experiment	• laboratory experiment • field experiment • quasi experiment.
Observation	• structured • unstructured • naturalistic • controlled • participant • non-participant • overt • covert.
Self-report	• questionnaire • Interviews: ○ structured, semi-structured, unstructured.
Correlation	• obtaining data for correlational analysis • positive correlation • negative correlation • no correlation.